

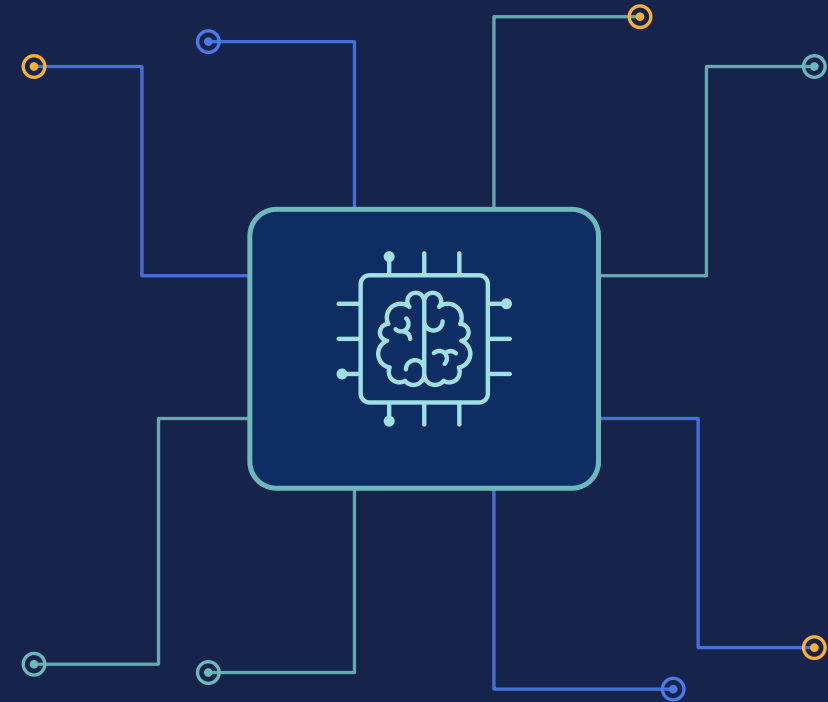
API VS AI GATEWAYS

WHAT'S THE DIFF?

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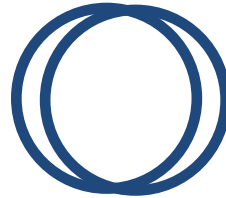




CONCLUSIONS



API & AI Gateway Differences



Very Similar: AI Gateways
Are a Subset of Functions



Thanks for Coming
to my PRDC Talk

Questions? 😊

WHAT'S AN API GATEWAY?

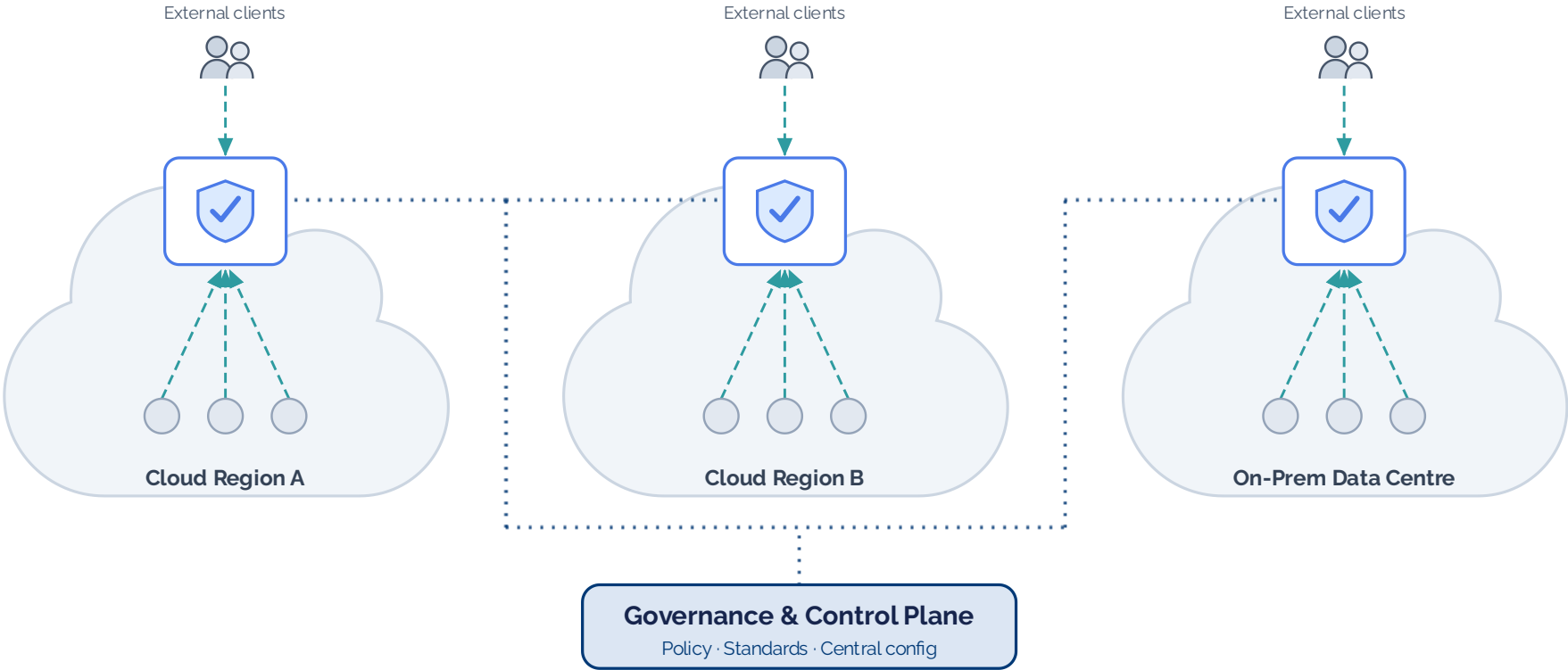
TYPES OF GATEWAY

Not all API Gateways are created equal or are intended for the same job. All of them have a history and unique issues or capabilities.



LAYER 7 FIREWALL

As a context aware load balancer and router, the API Gateway can be seen as a Layer 7 Firewall.



Every cloud region and data centre gets its own gateway. Policy stays central.

 API gateway
 --▶ Client traffic
 Governance / policy

THE GATEWAY BASICS

The API Gateway is often used very simply, and there are lots of products out there, but they all perform these basics.



**Accept and Validate
Request**



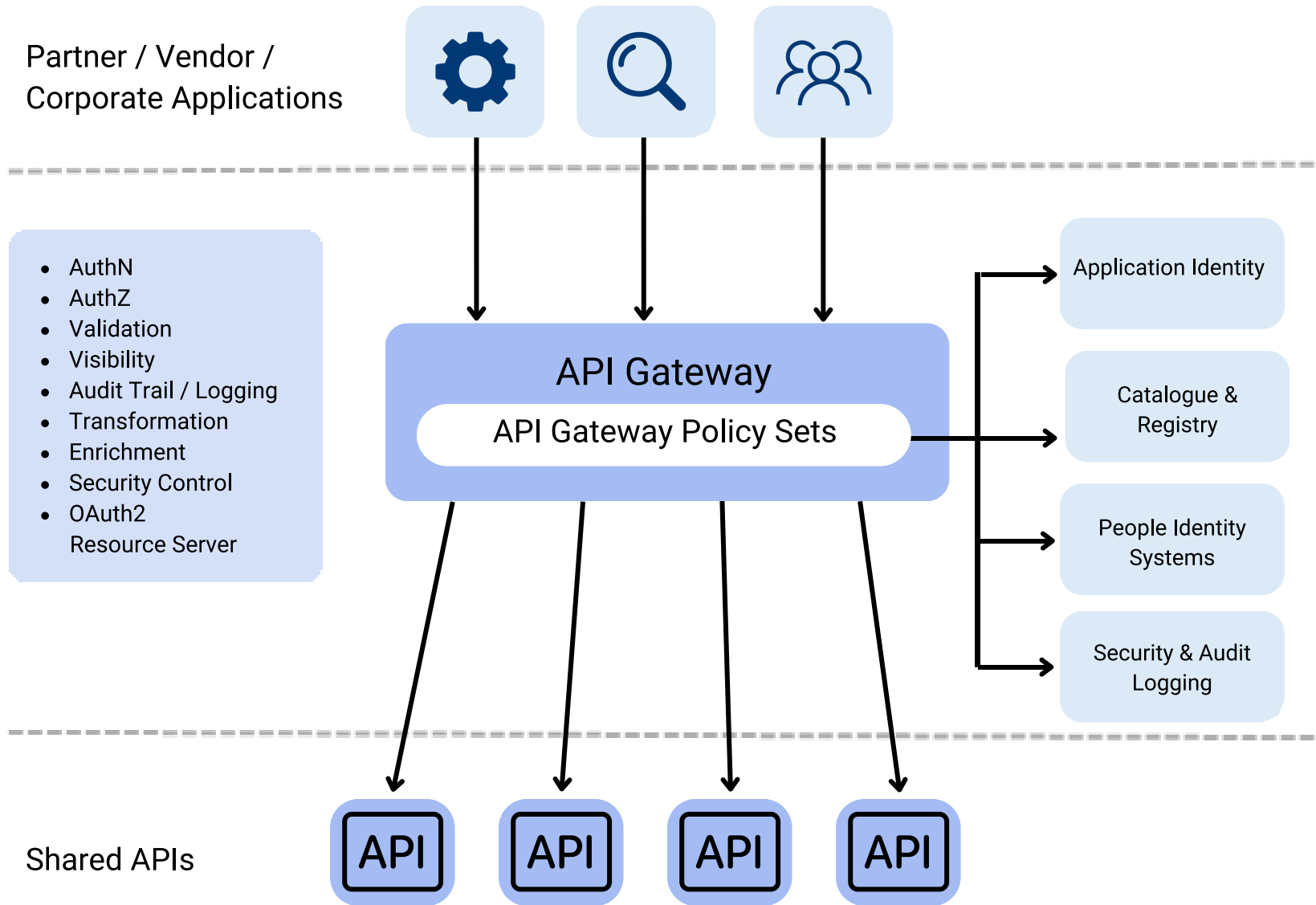
**Proxy the Request for
Known APIs**



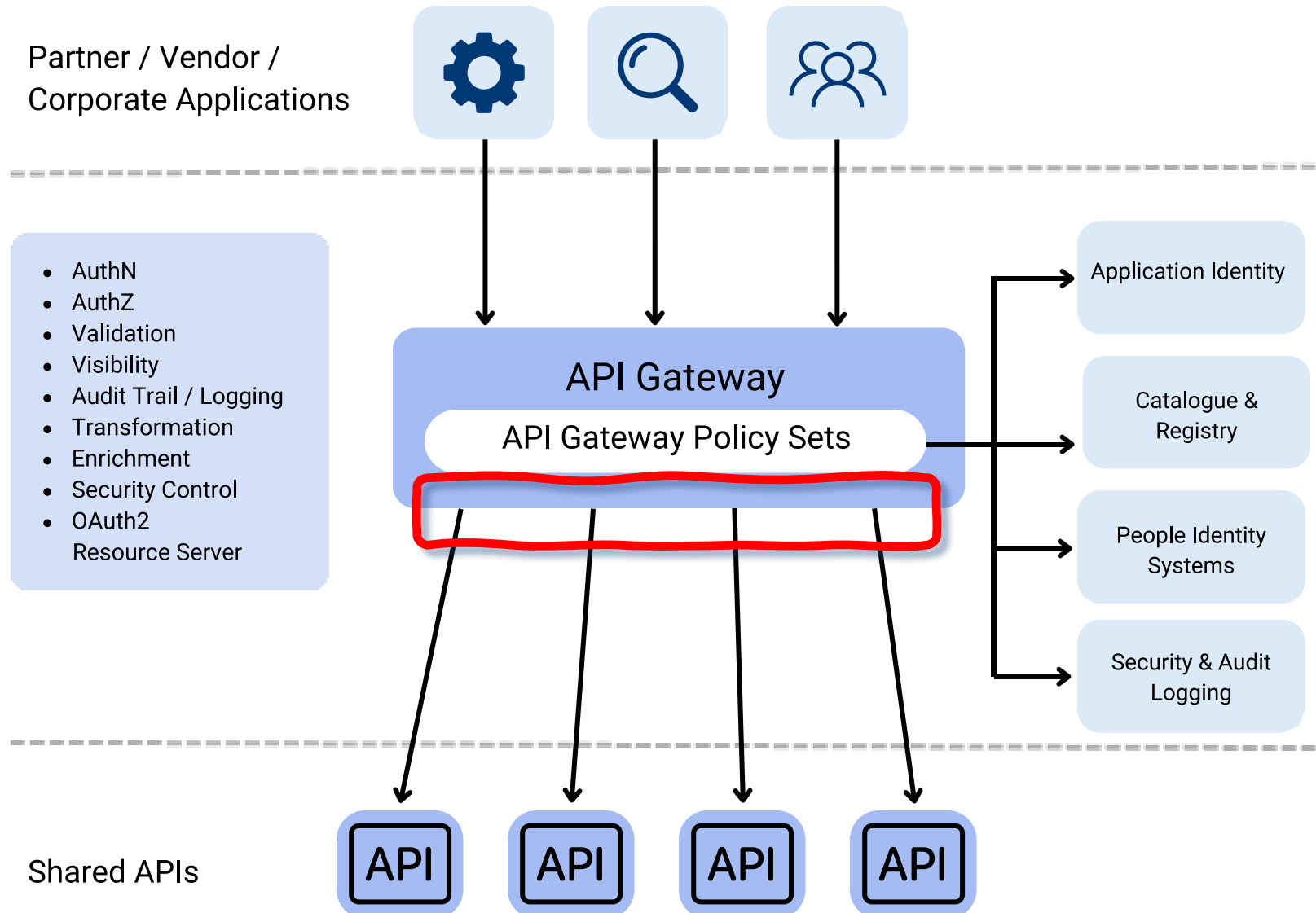
**Wait for and Return
Response**

ENTERPRISE API GATEWAY: THE POSSIBILITIES

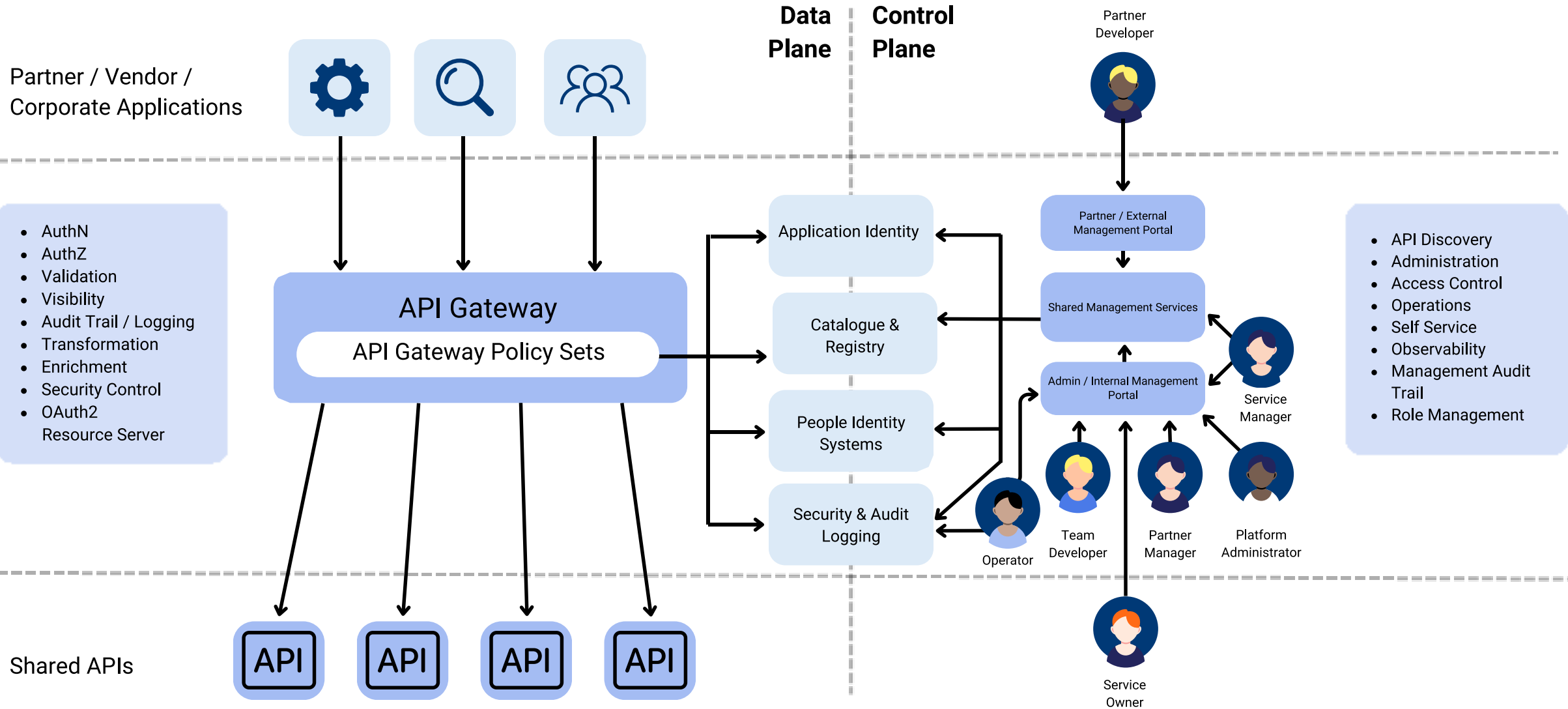
THE ENTERPRISE API GATEWAY



DATA PLANE POLICIES: ROUTING



CONTROL PLANE



AI GATEWAYS

AI GATEWAYS - THE USE CASE OVERLAP

The mature API Gateway already meets many of our AI Gateway needs 'out of the box'.



Token Logging



Prompt Logging



**The Basics –
Everything Else!**

AI GATEWAYS - THE 'NEW' USE CASES

Some AI use cases are genuinely new uses of an API Gateway, or may require specific implementations based on technology choices.



**Prompt Filtering /
Protection**



**Token Throttling
/ Metering**



Model AuthZ



**Long Lived /
Streaming Connections
(MCP)**



**Model (Payload)
Based Routing**

THE BENEFITS

Agentic AI projects take advantage of the API or AI Gateway, giving us much better safety.



**Billing, Charging,
& Limiting**



**Visibility &
Detection**



**Kill Switch &
Safety**



**Optimization, Protection,
& Scanning**

Thank you!
Questions (for real)?



Contact Me & Useful Links